



Genesis: Creation to Babel

Complete Workbook · Parts 1–4 · Genesis 1–11

KEYED TO THE ESV® BIBLE · THE WORD & WORLD ACADEMY

GENESIS: CREATION TO BABEL • PART 1

Part 1

Genesis 1–2

WHAT HAPPENS IN PART 1

In **Genesis 1**, God makes the heavens and the earth. At the start the earth has no shape and is covered in water and darkness. God speaks, and things come to be. On the first three days he makes empty places: **light** and dark, then **sky** and sea, then **dry land** and plants. On the next three days he fills them: sun, moon and stars for the day and night; fish and birds for the sea and sky; animals and people for the land. God makes people in his own **image** and tells them to care for the earth and the animals. Then God looks at everything he has made and calls it very good. On the seventh day he rests. **Genesis 2** then looks closer at that sixth day: God forms the first man from the dust of the ground and breathes life into him, plants a garden in Eden for him to work and keep, and brings the animals to him to be named. Seeing that the man is alone, God makes a woman from the man's own side, and the two become one family — “one flesh.”

WHAT WE WILL LEARN

Section

What you will practice

Word Study

Words the chapters are built from: create, separate, form, bless, image, breath, garden

Bible Study

How to read a list, and how to spot a pattern in a chapter

Scripture Discovery

The land and water of the ancient Near East, and why sea and sky mattered so much there

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Ch.

What happens

1

The Seven Days — The earth begins dark, deep and without shape. God speaks and light comes. Days one, two and three make room: day and night, sky and water, then dry land with plants and seeds. Days four, five and six fill that room: lights in the sky, fish and birds, then land animals and people. God makes people in his own image, male and female, and gives them the job of caring for the earth. He calls everything he has made very good. On the seventh day he stops working and rests.

2

The Garden — A closer look at the sixth day. God forms the man from the dust of the ground and breathes life into him. He plants a garden in Eden, with a river running through it, and puts the man there to work it and take care of it. God brings the animals to the man, who names them — but none of them is a fitting partner for him. So God makes a woman from the man's side, and the two are joined as one family.

PART 1

Word Study

Study 7 key words from Genesis 1–2, then answer each question.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **THE WORDS THAT BUILD A WORLD**

WORD STUDY · MAKING AND SORTING Look at what kind of words these chapters are made of.

Genesis 1 has making words: **create** means to make something new, and **separate** means to put two things apart. Genesis 2 zooms in and uses closer, hands-on words: to **form** something is to shape it, the way a potter shapes clay, and **breath** is the air that makes something alive. Learning both sets of words helps you see how the two chapters work together, one wide and fast, the other close and slow. A **garden** is where all of it happens — ground that has been made, sorted, and now cared for by **hand**.

create (v.)

Gen 1:1

To make something new

"The first line of the Bible says that God created the heavens and the earth."

separate (v.)

Gen 1:4

To put two things apart from each other

"God separated the light from the dark, and called them day and night."

bless (v.)

Gen 1:28

To wish or give someone good things, especially from God

"God blessed them and told them to be fruitful and multiply."

image (n.)

Gen 1:27

A picture or likeness of something

"The chapter says people were made in the image of God."

form (v.)

Gen 2:7

To shape or make something by hand

"The LORD God formed the man from the dust of the ground."

breath (n.)

Gen 2:7

The air a living thing takes in and lets out

"God breathed into the man's nostrils the breath of life."

garden (n.)

Gen 2:8

Ground where plants are grown and cared for

"God planted a garden in a place called Eden."

① The vocabulary words in this list are selected to help you understand and complete this workbook. Some may not appear word-for-word in your Bible.

1 To make something new is to ____ it.

(A) create

(B) gather

(C) form

(D) swarm

2 To 'separate' two things means to put them apart from each other.

TRUE

FALSE

3 Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices: **bless** **create** **form** **image** - some words will not be used

To wish God's good gifts on someone is to _____ them.

Check

4 Which word means 'a picture or likeness of something'?

(A) form

(B) image

(C) garden

(D) breath

5 To 'form' something means to shape it or make it by hand.

TRUE

FALSE

6 God breathed the 'breath of life' into the man's ears.

TRUE

FALSE

7

Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices:

garden

create

image

separate

- some words will not be used

God planted a _____ in a place called Eden, for the man to work and take care of it.

Check

PART 2

Understanding

Show you understood what happens in Genesis 1–2.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **HOW TO READ A CHAPTER THAT REPEATS**

BIBLE STUDY SKILL · SPOTTING A PATTERN

When a chapter says almost the same thing over and over, that is a clue, not a mistake. Try this. Write the six days in two short columns, days 1 to 3 on the left and days 4 to 6 on the right. Light and dark sit beside sun and moon. Sky and sea sit beside birds and fish. Land and plants sit beside animals and people. The left column makes an empty **place**. The right column **fills** it. Genesis 2 uses a different trick with the sixth day: it stops and looks closely instead of repeating. Finding a pattern, and noticing when a writer breaks one on purpose, are things a good Bible reader learns to **do**.

1

What is the earth like at the very start of the chapter?

- ☐ (A) dark, deep water with no shape
- ☐ (B) a dry desert with no water
- ☐ (C) a green field full of animals
- ☐ (D) a city with no people in it

2 What is the first thing God makes?

☐ A the animals

☐ B the sun

☐ C dry land

☐ D light

3 In Genesis 2, what does God use to form the man?

☐ A water from the river

☐ B one of his ribs

☐ C light from the sky

☐ D dust from the ground

4 What is made on the sixth day?

☐ A the sea and the sky

☐ B the stars

☐ C land animals and people

☐ D the plants

5 Write the numbers 1–5 in the boxes to show the correct order across Genesis 1–2. Number 1 = what happens first.

God says “Let there be light,” and there is light.

God plants a garden in a place called Eden.

The earth is dark and covered with water.

God makes a woman from the man’s own side.

God forms the man from the dust of the ground.

Check Order

6 God says that it is not good for the man to be alone.

TRUE

FALSE

7 The man and the woman become ‘one flesh,’ one family.

TRUE

FALSE

PART 3

Literary Craft

Understanding HOW and WHY Genesis 1–2 tells the story of creation twice, two different ways.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **TWO WAYS TO TELL ONE STORY**

LITERARY CRAFT · WIDE LENS, CLOSE LENS

Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 are not two different stories. They are one story told twice, in two different ways. Genesis 1 moves fast through the whole week, like a **list**: day one, day two, day three, all the way to day seven. Genesis 2 does something different. It slows all the way down and looks closely at just one part of day six — the man, the garden, the animals, the woman — like a **scene** instead of a line in a list. Zoom out, then zoom in. Both are true, and both are needed to see the whole **picture**.

PATTERN

Something that repeats. Genesis 1 repeats the same shape every day: God speaks, it happens, God sees it is good, evening and morning.

STRUCTURE

The way a piece of writing is put together. Genesis 1 moves fast, like a list of seven days. Genesis 2 slows down and tells one day, the sixth, like a close-up scene.

REFRAIN

A line that comes back again and again, like a chorus in a song. “And God saw that it was good” is the refrain of Genesis 1.

1 Something that repeats again and again is a ____.

(A) refrain

(B) seed

(C) pattern

(D) creature

2 Write your answer in each blank, then click Check.

Word choices: **pattern** **refrain** **seed** **image** - some words will not be used

A line that comes back again and again is a _____. **Check**

Something that repeats is a _____. **Check**

3 Days 1, 2 and 3 make empty places, and days 4, 5 and 6 fill them.

TRUE

FALSE

4 Genesis 2 tells about the whole week, from day one to day seven.

TRUE

FALSE

5 What does Genesis 2 do that Genesis 1 does not?

- ☐ (A) it lists all seven days
- ☐ (B) it zooms in on just one day
- ☐ (C) it talks about the stars
- ☐ (D) it ends with the Sabbath

6 Why does the writer put the same words at the end of each day in Genesis 1?

- ☐ (A) to show that each day was hard work
- ☐ (B) because there were no other words to use
- ☐ (C) to make the days feel like one whole week
- ☐ (D) to help people count to seven

7 Write your answer in each blank, then click Check.

Word choices: list scene song page - some words will not be used

Genesis 1 moves fast, like a _____.

Check

Genesis 2 slows down and tells one day like a _____.

Check

PART 4

Wisdom

Four deeper challenges — no single-word recall. Read, weigh the evidence, and reason it out.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **A NARROW LAND BETWEEN SEA AND DESERT**

SCRIPTURE DISCOVERY · PLACES & GEOGRAPHY The first people to read Genesis lived in

Canaan, where Israel is today — a thin strip of land on the eastern coast of the Mediterranean. A great **sea** lay to the west and a great **desert** to the east, with little room between. Rain fell in only one season, so towns were built wherever there was a spring or a well. That same geography matters for Genesis 2: the garden of **Eden** sits in this same world, watered by rivers the first readers knew. Keep that in mind as you read. A story that starts in dark water, makes dry **land**, and then plants a garden on it was speaking straight into the world its first readers **lived** in.

Read Genesis 1–2 in your Bible first. Then think about it. Genesis 1 is short but builds a whole world, fast. Genesis 2 slows all the way down and stays on just one day. Notice what each one is doing, and why the Bible needed both.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

1

Claim: "Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 tell one story in two different ways." — choose the **two** details that best prove it.

Genesis 1 moves through the whole week like a list

Genesis 2 slows down and tells one day like a scene

Genesis 2 has a sad ending

Genesis 1 has seven days in it

Genesis 2 never mentions God

Both chapters are about the same six days of making

Genesis 1 is written in a different language

Check (choose 2)

2 In Genesis 1, or in Genesis 2? **Tap each detail** to send it left or right. There are **3 details for each side**.

◀ In Genesis 1

In Genesis 2 ▶

TAP TO SORT Light is separated from the darkness

TAP TO SORT The man is formed from the dust of the ground

TAP TO SORT The sun, moon and stars are set in the sky

TAP TO SORT A garden is planted in a place called Eden

TAP TO SORT Land animals and people are made on the sixth day

TAP TO SORT A woman is made from the man's own side

Check

3 Match each detail on the left with what goes with it on the right.

Day 1 — light and dark → choose the result... ▼

Day 2 — sky and sea → choose the result... ▼

God forms the man from the dust → choose the result... ▼

The man is alone in the garden → choose the result... ▼

God sees everything he has made → choose the result... ▼

Check

4 Fill **both** blanks to complete the reasoning.

Genesis 2 slows down to tell about day six because

choose... ▾ , which shows that

choose... ▾ .

Check

World Discovery (SAT/TOEFL)

Reading passage · Land and Water in the Ancient Near East · practices the same reading-comprehension skills tested on the **SAT** and **TOEFL**: main idea, detail, vocabulary in context, inference and synthesis.

 Read the passage below (the **highlighted** words are tested), then answer the questions. **Tap an answer to select it, tap again to confirm** — you get one chance to change it before it's final.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

Land and Water in the Ancient Near East

The people who first read Genesis lived in **Canaan** — the same land where the country of Israel is today. It is a narrow strip of land on the eastern coast of the **Mediterranean Sea**, with a great desert on its other side. Water decided almost everything there. Rain came only in one season, so a village was built where a spring or a well was, and rivers like the **Jordan** were landmarks everyone knew. The sea to the west was not a holiday place. It was deep, dark and dangerous, and very few Israelites were sailors. That is worth remembering when you read Genesis 1. A chapter that begins with dark water and then makes dry land, and puts a sky over it and light in it, is describing the exact things those readers worried about most.

1 What is the passage mostly about?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Main Idea

- (A) how deep the Jordan River is
- (B) how to sail on the Mediterranean Sea
- (C) the best season to plant seeds
- (D) why land and water mattered so much

2 Where were villages built?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ A where a spring or a well was
- ☐ B on the beach beside the sea
- ☐ C on the highest hill
- ☐ D in the middle of the desert

3 In this passage, a “landmark” is ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Vocabulary in Context

- ☐ A a kind of boat
- ☐ B a kind of building
- ☐ C something everyone knows
- ☐ D a rule about land

4 You can guess from the passage that a well was ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Inference

- ☐ A easy to dig anywhere
- ☐ B very valuable
- ☐ C used only in winter
- ☐ D built beside the sea

5 In this passage, "narrow" means ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Vocabulary in Context

(A) not wide

(B) not deep

(C) very dry

(D) very old

6 Why does the passage say this matters for reading Genesis 1?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Inference

(A) the chapter says how much rain will fall

(B) the chapter was written beside the sea

(C) the chapter names the Jordan River

(D) the chapter makes what they cared about

7 Which day of Genesis 1 would matter most to a farmer with little rain?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Synthesis

(A) the first day, when light comes

(B) the third day, when land and plants come

(C) the fourth day, when the stars come

(D) the seventh day, when God rests

PART 6

Writing

A print-only writing prompt — not part of your online score.

Writing Task — Part 1 “Making Room, Then Filling It”

In Genesis 1, God makes an empty place first and then fills it. Think about a room, a box, a garden or a bag that you filled yourself. What was it like when it was empty? What did you put in it, and in what order? 4–6 sentences. End by saying one thing you were glad you put in last.

You can start with: *“When my box was empty, it looked...”*

Write your response on paper or in a notebook. This section is for print and take-home use; it is not scored online.

GENESIS: CREATION TO BABEL • PART 2

Part 2

Genesis 3–4

WHAT HAPPENS IN PART 2

In **Genesis 3**, a crafty serpent questions God's command. The woman and the man eat the fruit God told them not to eat. They notice that they are naked, make coverings from fig leaves, and hide. God questions them, and each person tells what happened. God speaks consequences to the serpent, the woman, and the man. The ground will now produce thorns and thistles, and growing food will be hard work. God makes garments for the man and woman and sends them out of Eden. In **Genesis 4**, Eve gives birth to Cain and Abel. Cain works the ground, while Abel keeps sheep. Both bring offerings from their work. After God regards Abel and his offering but not Cain and his offering, God questions and warns Cain. Cain later attacks his brother, and Abel dies. God sends Cain away as a wanderer but also protects him from retaliation. The chapter then follows later family members who build a city, keep livestock, make music, and work with metal. Life continues outside Eden, but it is no longer life in the garden.

WHAT WE WILL LEARN

Section	What you will practice
Word Study	Words for choices, work, care, and life outside Eden: crafty, offering, flock, keeper, wanderer, sin, forge
Bible Study	How to separate what a passage states from background information and inference
Scripture Discovery	Eden, early farming and shepherding, and the work of later family generations

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Ch.	What happens
3	The Garden Is Left Behind — The serpent questions God's command, and the woman and man eat the forbidden fruit. They make coverings and hide. God questions them and speaks consequences. The ground will produce thorns and thistles, making food harder to grow. God clothes the man and woman, sends them out of Eden to work the ground, and guards the way to the tree of life.
4	Family Life Outside Eden — Eve gives birth to Cain and Abel. Cain works the ground, and Abel keeps sheep. Both bring offerings. God questions and warns an angry Cain, but Cain later attacks Abel, who dies. Cain must wander, though God also protects him from retaliation. A family line then names people connected with a city, tents and livestock, music, and metalwork. Seth is born, and the chapter closes with another branch of the family.

PART 1

Word Study

Study 7 key words from Genesis 3–4, then answer each question.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **WORK WORDS AND A FAMILY QUESTION**

WORD STUDY · WORK AND RESPONSIBILITY Genesis 3–4 uses work words to show how life

changes. Outside Eden, the man must work the **ground**, and Cain becomes a worker of the ground. Abel is a keeper of sheep, caring for a **flock**. Both brothers bring an **offering** connected with their work. Later, Cain asks whether he is his brother's keeper. In the ESV, the English word **keeper** appears in both descriptions, but the underlying Hebrew verbs are different. Readers should not treat this as repeated Hebrew wordplay. Still, each English use involves watching over or caring for someone or something. Daily work and family care meet in the question of **responsibility**.

crafty (adj.)

Gen 3:1

Clever in a tricky or misleading way

"The serpent speaks in a crafty, tricky way."

offering (n.)

Gen 4:3–4

Something presented as a gift in worship or honor

"Each brother brings an offering connected with his work."

flock (n.)

Gen 4:4

A group of sheep or similar animals

"Abel brings firstborn animals from his flock."

keeper (n.)

Gen 4:2, 9

A person who watches over or cares for someone or something

"Abel keeps sheep, and Cain later asks about being his brother's keeper."

wanderer (n.)

Gen 4:12

A person who moves from place to place without a settled home

"Cain is told that he will become a wanderer on the earth."

sin (n.)

Gen 4:7

Wrongdoing that goes against what God wants

"God warns Cain that sin is crouching at the door, ready to control him."

forge (v.)

Gen 4:22

To shape metal, often with heat and hammering

"Tubal-cain is described as a forger of bronze and iron instruments."

① The vocabulary words in this list are selected to help you understand and complete this workbook. Some may not appear word-for-word in your Bible.

1 Someone who is clever in a tricky way is ____.

(A) careful

(B) worried

(C) crafty

(D) helpful

2 An 'offering' is something presented as a gift in worship or honor.

TRUE

FALSE

3 Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices: flock keeper forge crafty - some words will not be used

Abel brings firstborn animals from his _____.

Check

4 A person who watches over or cares for someone or something is a ____.

(A) keeper

(B) wanderer

(C) forger

(D) farmer

5 A 'wanderer' stays in one settled home.

TRUE

FALSE

6 In Genesis 4:7, 'sin' is pictured as something crouching at the door, ready to attack.

TRUE

FALSE

7

Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices:

forge

offering

keeper

wanderer

- some words will not be used

To shape metal with skilled work is to _____ it.

Check

PART 2

Understanding

Show you understood what happens in Genesis 3–4.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **WHAT THE OFFERING SCENE DOES NOT SAY**

CLOSE READING · OBSERVATION AND RESTRAINT

The offerings in Genesis 4 need close reading.

Cain brings an offering from the fruit of the **ground**. Abel brings from the firstborn of his **flock**, including fat portions. The chapter says the LORD regards Abel and his offering but does not regard Cain and his offering. It does not directly say that shepherding is better than farming, and it does not give one short sentence explaining the different response. Before Cain attacks Abel, God questions Cain and warns him about **sin**. A careful reader reports what the passage says and leaves an unstated reason marked as **unknown**.

1

What do the man and woman make after they eat the fruit?

- ☐ (A) a shelter from branches
- ☐ (B) a basket for the fruit
- ☐ (C) tools for the garden
- ☐ (D) coverings from fig leaves

2 What work does the man do after he leaves Eden?

- ☐ (A) he builds a boat
- ☐ (B) he works the ground
- ☐ (C) he watches a flock
- ☐ (D) he makes metal tools

3 How are Cain and Abel introduced by their work?

- ☐ (A) Cain herds; Abel builds a city
- ☐ (B) Cain farms; Abel keeps sheep
- ☐ (C) Cain forges; Abel makes music
- ☐ (D) Cain travels; Abel farms

4 What do the brothers bring as offerings?

- ☐ (A) bread and jars of water
- ☐ (B) tools and woven cloth
- ☐ (C) wood and shaped stones
- ☐ (D) produce and firstborn animals

5 Write the numbers 1–5 in the boxes to show the correct order across Genesis 3–4. Number 1 = what happens first.

The man and woman are sent out of Eden.

Cain works the ground, and Abel keeps sheep.

The serpent questions God's command in the garden.

The brothers bring offerings connected with their work.

Eve gives birth to Cain and then Abel.

Check Order

6 God warns Cain about sin before the next scene in the field.

TRUE

FALSE

7 Genesis 4 says that shepherding is better than farming.

TRUE

FALSE

PART 3

Literary Craft

Understanding HOW and WHY Genesis tells the story across Genesis 3–4.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **QUESTIONS ACROSS TWO FAMILY STORIES**

LITERARY CRAFT · QUESTIONS AND DIALOGUE

Questions shape both chapters. After the man and woman hide, God asks where the man is, who told him he was naked, and whether he ate from the tree. God then asks the woman what she has done. In Genesis 4, God asks Cain why he is angry, where Abel is, and what he has done. The narrative places each **question** before an answer, a warning, or a consequence. Repeated questions can slow the action and draw attention to what each person says. This pattern helps readers compare the two family stories and think about **dialogue**, **repetition**, and **responsibility**.

CONTRAST

A difference placed side by side. Genesis 4 places a worker of the ground beside a keeper of sheep without saying that either job is better.

DIALOGUE

Words spoken by characters. Questions and answers carry much of the action in Genesis 3 and 4.

GENEALOGY

A record that traces a family line. The later part of Genesis 4 follows children and descendants across several generations.

1 What is a contrast?

- ☐ (A) a difference shown side by side
- ☐ (B) a list of family names
- ☐ (C) a speech between characters
- ☐ (D) a pattern of repeated words

2 Fill in each blank with the correct word.

Word choices: **dialogue** **contrast** **genealogy** **offering** - *some words will not be used*

Words spoken by characters are called _____.

A difference placed side by side is a _____.

3 Which feature appears in both Genesis 3 and Genesis 4?

- ☐ (A) a long list of kings
- ☐ (B) a journey across the sea
- ☐ (C) questions followed by answers
- ☐ (D) instructions for an ark

4 A genealogy traces people in a family line.

TRUE

FALSE

5 A genealogy is a list of farming tools.

TRUE

FALSE

6 Fill in each blank with the correct word.

Word choices: **genealogy** **dialogue** **flock** **wanderer** - some words will not be used

The family record near the end of Genesis 4 is a _____.

Check

God's questions and Cain's replies are _____.

Check

7 What does the family record add near the end of Genesis 4?

(A) a second description of Eden

(B) directions for building an ark

(C) a list of plants in a garden

(D) new generations and kinds of work

PART 4

Wisdom

Four deeper challenges — no single-word recall. Read, weigh the evidence, and reason it out.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **FARMERS AND SHEPHERDS IN THE SAME REGION**

DAILY LIFE · FARMING AND SHEPHERDING

Genesis 4 places a farmer and a shepherd in the same family. Archaeology shows that crop cultivation and herd management both appeared early in Southwest Asia, though the evidence does not date Cain and Abel. Early farming involved cultivating **plants**, while herding involved managing animals such as sheep and goats. At some ancient sites, evidence of both occurs together. This shows that farming and herding could be part of the same **community**. This background helps us picture the brothers' occupations, but it does not explain why God responded differently to their offerings. The chapter does not call either **occupation superior**.

Read Genesis 3–4 in your Bible first. Follow the move from the garden to life outside Eden. Then watch how the ground returns: the man is sent to work it, Cain works it, Abel keeps sheep, and the brothers bring offerings connected with their work. Notice the questions God asks in both chapters. Some details are stated directly, while other explanations are left unstated. Keep those two kinds of information separate.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

1

Claim: "Genesis 4 connects family generations with different kinds of work." — choose the **three** details that best support it.

Abel keeps sheep.

Cain works the ground.

Cain settles in the land of Nod.

God asks Cain where Abel is.

Eve gives birth to Cain.

Tubal-cain forges instruments of bronze and iron.

Cain names a city after Enoch.

Check (choose 3)

2 Stated in Genesis 3–4, or Not stated there? **Tap each** detail to send it left or right.

◀ **Stated in Genesis 3–4**

Not stated there ▶

TAP TO SORT Cain is a worker of the ground.

TAP TO SORT The forbidden fruit is an apple.

TAP TO SORT Abel is a keeper of sheep.

TAP TO SORT Shepherding is better than farming.

TAP TO SORT Both brothers bring offerings.

TAP TO SORT Archaeology proves the date of Cain's life.

Check

3 Match each first detail with the detail paired with it.

The man after Eden → choose the matching detail... ▼

Cain → choose the matching detail... ▼

Abel → choose the matching detail... ▼

Jabal → choose the matching detail... ▼

Tubal-cain → choose the matching detail... ▼

Check

4 Fill **both** blanks to complete the reasoning.

Genesis 4 introduces Cain as a worker of the ground and Abel as a keeper of sheep

choose... ▼ , which shows that

choose... ▼ .

Check

World Discovery (SAT/TOEFL)

Reading passage · Farming and Herding in Southwest Asia · Background and Textual Evidence · practices the same reading-comprehension skills tested on the **SAT** and **TOEFL**: main idea, detail, vocabulary in context, inference and synthesis.

 Read the passage below (the **highlighted** words are tested), then answer the questions. **Tap an answer to select it, tap again to confirm** — you get one chance to change it before it's final.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

Farming and Herding in Southwest Asia

Genesis 4 introduces Cain and Abel by the work they do. Cain works the ground, while Abel keeps sheep. Archaeologists studying Southwest Asia find evidence that crop cultivation and herd management both appeared early in the region, sometimes in the same communities. Plant remains and animal bones help researchers identify these activities. This **background** helps readers picture a farmer tending crops and a shepherd caring for a flock, but it does not tell us when Cain and Abel lived or prove the story's location. In the chapter, each brother brings an offering connected with his work: Cain brings produce from the ground, and Abel brings firstborn animals from his flock. The text says God regards Abel and his offering but not Cain and his offering. It does not say that shepherding itself is better than farming. Good background knowledge adds a clearer picture while careful reading keeps it separate from what the passage directly states.

1 What is the passage mostly about?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Main Idea

- ☐ (A) why one brother chose to leave home
- ☐ (B) how background helps without proving details
- ☐ (C) how ancient metalworkers shaped tools
- ☐ (D) why shepherds traveled farther than farmers

2

What evidence helps researchers identify ancient work?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) written diaries and road maps
- ☐ (B) royal crowns and family lists
- ☐ (C) plant remains and animal bones
- ☐ (D) city gates and sailing ships

3

In this passage, "background" means ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Vocabulary in Context

- ☐ (A) helpful context
- ☐ (B) a place behind a building
- ☐ (C) a picture under the words
- ☐ (D) a sound heard from far away

4

How is each brother's offering connected with his work?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) Both bring tools used in their jobs.
- ☐ (B) Each brings a gift tied to his work.
- ☐ (C) Both bring food grown from the soil.
- ☐ (D) Each brings an animal from the flock.

5 Why does the passage say this archaeological background does not date Cain and Abel?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Inference

- ☐ (A) to show that ancient work left no evidence
- ☐ (B) to claim that farming began somewhere else
- ☐ (C) to separate background from unstated details
- ☐ (D) to prove that the brothers lived in one city

6 Which statement is supported by the reading passage?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Evidence

- ☐ (A) Every ancient family kept sheep and cattle.
- ☐ (B) Only shepherds brought offerings in the region.
- ☐ (C) Farmers never lived near people with flocks.
- ☐ (D) Some communities combined farming and herding.

7 Which rule for careful reading does the passage model?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Synthesis

- ☐ (A) Use background to picture the text without claiming proof.
- ☐ (B) Let archaeology decide every unstated question.
- ☐ (C) Assume different jobs must compete with one another.
- ☐ (D) Treat a later custom as the cause of an earlier event.

Writing

A print-only writing prompt — not part of your online score.

Writing Task — Part 2 “Being Someone's Keeper”

In Genesis 4, God asks Cain, ‘Where is your brother?’ and Cain answers, ‘Am I my brother's keeper?’ Think of a time you helped take care of someone — a brother, sister, friend, or pet. What did you do, and how did it feel to be someone's ‘keeper’? 4–6 sentences. End by saying one way you could be a good ‘keeper’ this week.

You can start with: *“One time I helped take care of...”*

Write your response on paper or in a notebook. This section is for print and take-home use; it is not scored online.

GENESIS: CREATION TO BABEL • PART 3

Part 3

Genesis 5–7

WHAT HAPPENS IN PART 3

Genesis 5 traces a family line from Adam to Noah and Noah's sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth. A repeated pattern records each generation, and Enoch's notice breaks that pattern. In **Genesis 6**, God sees that human wickedness has become great and that the earth is corrupt and full of violence. Noah finds favor with God. God tells Noah that judgment is coming and gives detailed instructions for an ark. It is to have rooms, three levels, a side door, and pitch inside and outside. God tells Noah to bring his family, animals, and stored food into the ark. Noah does what God commands. In **Genesis 7**, Noah enters with his wife, his three sons, and their wives. Clean animals and birds come in greater numbers than animals that are not clean. Rain falls for forty days and forty nights. The waters rise, lift the ark, and cover the land described in the account. The chapter closes while the waters are still prevailing.

WHAT WE WILL LEARN

Section	What you will practice
Word Study	Words for family lines, measurement, promises, animals, and rising waters: righteous, ark, pitch, cubit, covenant, clean, prevail
Bible Study	How repeated patterns, precise details, and careful sequence help readers follow Genesis 5–7
Scripture Discovery	Ancient measuring units, waterproof boat coatings, flood traditions, and the passage's animal groups

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Ch.	What happens
5	A Family Line Reaches Noah — A genealogy follows Adam's family through many generations. Most entries repeat a pattern of life, children, years, and death, while Enoch's notice is different. Lamech names his son Noah and speaks of hoped-for relief. Noah later becomes the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
6	God Gives Instructions for the Ark — The account describes human wickedness, corruption, and violence, but Noah finds favor with God. God announces judgment and tells Noah to make an ark. He gives its dimensions and features, promises to establish a covenant with Noah, and tells him to preserve his family, animals, and food. Noah does what God commands.
7	Noah Enters and the Waters Rise — Noah's family and the animals enter the ark. The chapter distinguishes clean animals and birds from animals that are not clean. Rain falls for forty days and nights, and rising waters lift the ark so that it floats. The waters continue to prevail for 150 days.

PART 1

Word Study

Study 7 key words from Genesis 5–7, then answer each question.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **MEASURING THE ARK IN CUBITS**

WORD STUDY · ANCIENT MEASUREMENT

Genesis gives the ark's length, width, and height in **cubits**. A cubit was an ancient unit based on the **forearm**, but its exact length could vary across times and places. Surviving measuring **rods** show that ancient builders used standard units. The biblical dimensions are 300 cubits long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. Those numbers give clear **proportions**: the length is six times the width and ten times the height. They do not supply one certain conversion into modern feet or meters. We can compare the ark's dimensions with care while keeping an exact modern size **approximate**.

righteous (adj.)

Gen 6:9

Living in a way that pleases God; doing what is right

"The passage describes Noah as righteous and blameless in his generation."

ark (n.)

Gen 6:14

The large vessel Noah is told to build

"Noah builds the ark according to God's instructions."

pitch (n.)

Gen 6:14

A material used to seal a surface against water

"Noah is told to coat the ark with pitch inside and outside."

cubit (n.)

Gen 6:15

An ancient unit of length based on the forearm

"The ark's dimensions are given in cubits."

covenant (n.)

Gen 6:18

A solemn promise or agreement that establishes a commitment

"God promises to establish a covenant with Noah."

clean (adj.)

Gen 7:2–3

Belonging to a biblical category named in the passage

"Clean animals and birds enter in greater numbers."

prevail (v.)

Gen 7:24

To continue strongly or become powerful

"The waters prevail on the earth for 150 days."

① The vocabulary words in this list are selected to help you understand and complete this workbook. Some may not appear word-for-word in your Bible.

1 Someone who lives in a way that pleases God is described as ____.

(A) wealthy

(B) famous

(C) righteous

(D) clever

2 In Genesis 6, an 'ark' is the large vessel Noah is told to build.

TRUE

FALSE

3 Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices: pitch cubit clean prevail - some words will not be used

Noah is told to coat the ark with _____ inside and outside.

Check

4 Which word names an ancient unit based on the forearm?

(A) cubit

(B) covenant

(C) generation

(D) pitch

5 A 'covenant' is a solemn promise or agreement that establishes a commitment.

TRUE

FALSE

6 In Genesis 7, 'clean' simply means freshly washed.

TRUE

FALSE

7

Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices:

prevail

righteous

ark

covenant

- some words will not be used

To continue strongly or become powerful is to _____.

Check

Understanding

Show you understood what happens in Genesis 5–7.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **COUNT THE ANIMALS CAREFULLY**

CLOSE READING · GENERAL AND SPECIFIC INSTRUCTIONS Genesis 6 first gives a general

instruction: two of every sort of living creature are to be kept alive. Genesis 7 adds a more specific distinction. **Clean** animals and **birds** come in greater numbers than animals that are not clean. The chapter names these groups but does not explain the later biblical rules for them. It also uses broad creature groups and the phrase “according to their kinds,” not modern scientific species. Saying “exactly two of every animal” would flatten the two instructions into one. A careful reader keeps the general statement beside the added **detail** and reads both **carefully**.

1 What does Genesis 5 trace from Adam to Noah?

(A) a list of cities

(B) a set of laws

(C) a sailing route

(D) a family line

2 What does the account say about Noah before the ark instructions?

- ☐ (A) He rules over a city.
- ☐ (B) He finds favor with God.
- ☐ (C) He invents metal tools.
- ☐ (D) He sails to a new land.

3 What conditions does Genesis 6 connect with the announced judgment?

- ☐ (A) wealth and safety
- ☐ (B) violence and corruption
- ☐ (C) music and feasting
- ☐ (D) roads and towers

4 Which detail is included in God's ark instructions?

- ☐ (A) a sail made of cloth
- ☐ (B) a rudder at the back
- ☐ (C) oars along both sides
- ☐ (D) pitch inside and outside

5 Write the numbers 1–5 in the boxes to show the correct order across Genesis 5–7. Number 1 = what happens first.

The earth is described as corrupt and violent.

Noah's family and the animals enter the ark.

A family line reaches Noah and his sons.

Rain falls, and the waters lift the ark.

God gives Noah instructions for the ark.

Check Order

6 Noah does what God commands him to do.

TRUE

FALSE

7 Genesis 6–7 says that every animal group enters in exactly the same number.

TRUE

FALSE

PART 3

Literary Craft

Understanding HOW and WHY Genesis tells the story across Genesis 5–7.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **A REFRAIN AND AN EXCEPTION**

LITERARY CRAFT · REPETITION AND CONTRAST

Genesis 5 is a **genealogy**, a record that traces a family line. Many entries follow a repeated **pattern**: a person's age is given, a son is named, other children are mentioned, the full lifespan is counted, and the person dies. The closing notice acts like a **refrain**. Enoch's entry is an **exception**. Instead of the usual ending, the account says that he walks with God and that God takes him. Repetition can train readers to expect what comes next. When the pattern changes, the difference receives special attention. The repeated ending and Enoch's different ending create a clear **contrast**.

GENEALOGY

A record that traces people in a family line. Genesis 5 follows generations from Adam to Noah and his sons.

REFRAIN

A line or pattern that returns several times. Many Genesis 5 entries close by reporting the person's death.

EXCEPTION

A case that does not follow the usual pattern. Enoch's notice ends differently from the entries around it.

1 What is a genealogy?

- ☐ (A) a record of a family line
- ☐ (B) a plan for a large vessel
- ☐ (C) a list of animal groups
- ☐ (D) a measure of water depth

2 Fill in each blank with the correct word.

Word choices: **genealogy** **refrain** **exception** **cubit** - some words will not be used

A repeated line or pattern is a _____.

Check

A case that breaks the usual pattern is an _____.

Check

3 Which notice returns at the end of many Genesis 5 entries?

- ☐ (A) the person builds a city
- ☐ (B) the person leaves the land
- ☐ (C) the person dies
- ☐ (D) the person enters an ark

4 Enoch's notice follows the same ending as every entry around it.

TRUE

FALSE

5 A repeated pattern can make a changed ending easier to notice.

TRUE

FALSE

6 Fill in each blank with the correct word.

Word choices: **genealogy** **refrain** **pitch** **covenant** - some words will not be used

Genesis 5 is a _____ that traces a family line.

Check

Its repeated closing notice acts like a _____.

Check

7 How does Genesis 5 prepare for the chapters that follow?

(A) It explains every kind of animal.

(B) It gives the full design of the ark.

(C) It describes the rising flood waters.

(D) It traces the family to Noah and his sons.

PART 4

Wisdom

Four deeper challenges — no single-word recall. Read, weigh the evidence, and reason it out.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **ANCIENT BOATS AND WATERPROOF COATINGS**

ARCHAEOLOGY · MATERIAL EVIDENCE

Genesis calls Noah's vessel an **ark** and says it is coated with **pitch** inside and outside. The account gives rooms, three levels, and a side door, but it mentions no sail, oars, or rudder. Archaeologists have found ancient Near Eastern boat remains and models with **bitumen**, a dark material used to help keep water out. One ancient boat found near Uruk preserved impressions of plant material beneath its coating. Such finds show that waterproof coatings were part of ancient boatbuilding. They help readers picture a material detail in Genesis, but they do not prove the ark's date, place, shape, or construction. Background must stay separate from the passage's direct **statements**.

Read Genesis 5–7 in your Bible first. Follow the family line until it reaches Noah and his sons. Then notice why judgment is announced, which ark details God gives, and how Noah responds. Keep the general animal instruction in Genesis 6 beside the more specific distinction in Genesis 7. Finally, track the time statements: rain falls for forty days and nights, while the waters prevail for 150 days. Report each detail at the level the passage gives it.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

1

Claim: "Genesis 6–7 presents Noah obeying instructions that preserve life." — choose the **three** details that best support it.

Noah gathers food for his household and the animals.

Noah makes the ark as God commands.

Rain falls for forty days and forty nights.

The waters lift the ark above the earth.

Noah is six hundred years old when the flood waters come.

Noah enters the ark with his household and the animals.

The waters prevail for 150 days.

Check (choose 3)

2 Stated in Genesis 5–7, or Not stated there? **Tap each** detail to send it left or right.

◀ Stated in Genesis 5–7

Not stated there ▶

TAP TO SORT The ark has three levels.

TAP TO SORT Gopher wood is certainly cypress.

TAP TO SORT Noah enters with his wife, sons, and sons' wives.

TAP TO SORT A crowd mocks Noah while he builds.

TAP TO SORT Rain falls for forty days and nights.

TAP TO SORT The entire flood ends after forty days.

Check

3 Match each first detail with the detail paired with it.

Genesis 5 → choose the matching detail... ▼

Cubit → choose the matching detail... ▼

Pitch → choose the matching detail... ▼

Clean animals and birds → choose the matching detail... ▼

Rain → choose the matching detail... ▼

Check

4 Fill **both** blanks to complete the reasoning.

Genesis gives the ark's length, width, and height in cubits, so readers can

choose... , which shows that

choose... .

Check

World Discovery (SAT/TOEFL)

Reading passage · A Flood Story on a Clay Tablet · Ancient Texts and Careful Comparison · practices the same reading-comprehension skills tested on the **SAT** and **TOEFL**: main idea, detail, vocabulary in context, inference and synthesis.

 Read the passage below (the **highlighted** words are tested), then answer the questions. **Tap an answer to select it, tap again to confirm** — you get one chance to change it before it's final.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

A Flood Story on a Clay Tablet

At the British Museum, a clay tablet from seventh-century BCE Nineveh **preserves** part of the Epic of Gilgamesh. Its cuneiform writing uses wedge-shaped signs pressed into clay. The story on this tablet includes a flood survivor who reports a warning and the building of a boat. It also mentions family members, animals, birds, and a sacrifice. These details create real similarities with the Genesis flood account, while other details differ, including the gods, the reason for the flood, and the boat's design. The object's date tells when this surviving copy was made, not when the flood it describes occurred. Its existence alone cannot prove that Genesis borrowed from it or that either account happened exactly as described. The tablet is evidence that a flood story was written in ancient Mesopotamia. A careful comparison states that evidence, examines both similarities and differences, and leaves larger conclusions qualified.

1 What is the passage mostly about?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Main Idea

- ☐ (A) why all flood stories describe one event
- ☐ (B) how one tablet informs a careful comparison
- ☐ (C) how builders tested boats on major rivers
- ☐ (D) why clay replaced every other writing material

2 What material and writing system does the passage name?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) stone with painted symbols
- ☐ (B) papyrus with inked letters
- ☐ (C) clay with cuneiform signs
- ☐ (D) wood with carved pictures

3 In this passage, “preserves” most nearly means ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Vocabulary in Context

- ☐ (A) keeps so it can survive
- ☐ (B) hides so no one can read
- ☐ (C) changes into a new story
- ☐ (D) translates into another language

4 What does the tablet's seventh-century BCE date establish?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) when the flood itself occurred
- ☐ (B) when this tablet copy was made
- ☐ (C) when Genesis was first written
- ☐ (D) when all flood stories began

5 Why does the passage mention both similarities and differences?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Author's Method

- ☐ (A) to show all ancient boats had one design
- ☐ (B) to prove the tablet records Genesis directly
- ☐ (C) to compare without calling the stories identical
- ☐ (D) to decide which museum owns older clay

6 Which statement is supported by the passage?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Evidence

- ☐ (A) The tablet records Noah's own spoken words.
- ☐ (B) The boat design matches Genesis in every detail.
- ☐ (C) The artifact was written during the flood.
- ☐ (D) A Mesopotamian tablet contains a flood story.

7 Which method does the final sentence recommend?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Synthesis

- ☐ (A) State what the object shows and qualify further claims.
- ☐ (B) Treat every similarity as proof of direct copying.
- ☐ (C) Ignore differences between the ancient accounts.
- ☐ (D) Use a later copy to date the event it describes.

Writing

A print-only writing prompt — not part of your online score.

Writing Task — Part 3 “Building Something You Can't Test Yet”

Noah built the ark for years before it ever rained. Think of a time you worked on something big before you knew whether it would work — a project, a drawing, or practicing a new skill. What did you build or work on, and how did you keep going? 4–6 sentences. End by saying what helped you keep working even when you weren't sure yet.

You can start with: *“I once worked on...”*

Write your response on paper or in a notebook. This section is for print and take-home use; it is not scored online.

GENESIS: CREATION TO BABEL • PART 4

Part 4

Genesis 8–11

WHAT HAPPENS IN PART 4

Genesis 8 follows Noah as he waits for the flood waters to go down. He sends out a raven, then a dove three separate times, watching closely what each flight shows him. Once the earth is finally dry, God tells Noah to bring his family and every animal out of the ark. Noah's first act outside the ark is to build an altar and offer a sacrifice to the LORD. In **Genesis 9**, God blesses Noah's family, tells them to be fruitful and multiply, and promises never again to destroy every living thing with a flood. He gives the bow in the clouds as a lasting sign of that promise. **Genesis 10** then traces the many descendants of Noah's three sons and connects them with the different nations, peoples, and languages spread across the ancient world. **Genesis 11** zooms in on one group who share a single language. They settle in the land of Shinar and decide to build a city and a tower out of brick and bitumen, hoping to make a name for themselves. God confuses their language, they are dispersed across the earth, and the place is named Babel.

WHAT WE WILL LEARN

Section	What you will practice
Word Study	Words for waiting, worship, promises, and city-building: sacrifice, altar, sign, Shinar, mortar, dispersed, confuse
Bible Study	How to track what changes across a repeated test, and how to notice a symbol and a stated motive
Scripture Discovery	Ancient building materials, real ziggurats, and the many languages once spoken across ancient Mesopotamia

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Ch.

What happens

8

The Waters Go Down — Noah sends out a raven, then a dove three separate times, watching what each flight shows about the flood. Once the earth is dry, God tells Noah to bring his family and every animal out of the ark. Noah builds an altar and offers a sacrifice to the LORD.

9

A Promise and a Sign — God blesses Noah and his sons, tells them to be fruitful and multiply, and gives them permission to eat animals for food. God then promises never again to destroy every living thing with a flood, and gives the bow in the clouds as the sign of that lasting promise.

10

Many Nations — A long family record traces the descendants of Noah's three sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth, connecting different family lines with different nations, peoples, and languages spread across the ancient world.

11

One Language, One City — People who share one language settle in the land of Shinar and decide to build a city and a tower, so that they will make a name for themselves and not be dispersed. God confuses their language, and the people are dispersed across the earth after all; the place is named Babel.

PART 1

Word Study

Study 7 key words from Genesis 8–11, then answer each question.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **BRICKS INSTEAD OF STONE**

WORD STUDY · ANCIENT BUILDING MATERIALS

Genesis 11 says the builders had **brick** for stone and **bitumen** for mortar. That detail matches real ancient Mesopotamia. Unlike Egypt or Canaan, the land between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers had very little natural stone. Builders instead shaped wet river clay into bricks and dried or baked them hard. Bitumen, a sticky, tar-like substance that seeps naturally from the ground in parts of the ancient Near East, could be used the way **mortar** holds stones together today. Archaeologists have excavated brick walls and bitumen-sealed structures across the region, from house foundations to city walls. The passage's building materials fit the world it **describes**.

sacrifice (n.)

Gen 8:20

Something given up and offered to God, often on an altar

"Noah offers a sacrifice to the LORD once he leaves the ark."

altar (n.)

Gen 8:20

A raised structure used for offering a sacrifice

"Noah builds an altar and offers a sacrifice to the LORD."

sign (n.)

Gen 9:12

A visible mark that stands for something else

"The bow in the clouds is given as a sign of God's promise."

Shinar (n.)

Gen 11:2

The land where the people settle and build a city

"The people find a plain in the land of Shinar and settle there."

mortar (n.)

Gen 11:3

A material used to hold building blocks together

"The builders use bitumen for mortar instead of stone."

dispersed (v.)

Gen 11:4, 9

Spread out or scattered in different directions

"The people build a tower so that they will not be dispersed."

confuse (v.)

Gen 11:7

To make something unclear or hard to understand

"God chooses to confuse the language of the people at Babel."

① The vocabulary words in this list are selected to help you understand and complete this workbook. Some may not appear word-for-word in your Bible.

1 Something given up and offered to God, often on an altar, is called a ____.

(A) prayer

(B) festival

(C) sacrifice

(D) harvest

2 In Genesis 8, an 'altar' is a place Noah builds for offering a sacrifice to the LORD.

TRUE

FALSE

3 Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices: sign altar mortar dispersed - some words will not be used

The bow in the clouds is called a _____ of God's promise never to flood the whole earth again.

4 Which word names the land where the people settle and decide to build a city and a tower?

☐ A Shinar

☐ B Ararat

☐ C Canaan

☐ D Eden

5 In Genesis 11, the builders use bitumen the way mortar is used to hold stones together.

6 In Genesis 11, the people build a city and a tower so that they will be dispersed across the earth.

7

Write your answer in the blank, then click Check.

Word choices:

confuse

sacrifice

Shinar

mortar

- some words will not be used

God is described as choosing to _____ the language of the people so they can no longer understand each other.

Check

Understanding

Show you understood what happens in Genesis 8–11.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **READING A REPEATED TEST**

CLOSE READING · REPETITION WITH A CHANGE

Genesis 8 describes Noah testing the flood waters three separate times. First he sends out a raven. Then he sends a dove, which finds no place to land and comes back. A week later he sends the dove again, and it returns carrying a freshly plucked **olive leaf**. A week after that, he sends the dove a third time, and it does not return at all. Each attempt repeats the same basic action — sending a bird — but the **result** changes every time. A careful reader tracks what stays the same and what changes across a repeated test, since the changes are exactly how the passage shows the waters slowly going **down**.

1

What does Noah do first to test whether the flood waters have gone down?

- ☐ (A) He sends out a dove.
- ☐ (B) He climbs onto the roof of the ark.
- ☐ (C) He opens a window and looks himself.
- ☐ (D) He sends out a raven.

2 What happens the first time Noah sends out the dove?

- ☐ A It brings back an olive leaf.
- ☐ B It finds no place to land and comes back.
- ☐ C It does not return at all.
- ☐ D It builds a nest on the mountains of Ararat.

3 What does the dove bring back on its second flight?

- ☐ A A handful of dry soil
- ☐ B A freshly plucked olive leaf
- ☐ C A small twig from a cedar tree
- ☐ D A grain of wheat

4 What does Noah do once he and his family leave the ark?

- ☐ A He plants a vineyard right away.
- ☐ B He builds a city in Shinar.
- ☐ C He divides the land among his sons.
- ☐ D He builds an altar to the LORD.

5 Write the numbers 1–5 in the boxes to show the correct order across Genesis 8–11. Number 1 = what happens first.

#

God gives the bow as a sign of his promise.

#

The people decide to build a city and a tower.

#

Noah sends out a raven from the ark.

#

God confuses their language, and they are dispersed.

#

The people settle in the land of Shinar.

Check Order

6 God tells Noah to bring his family and every kind of animal out of the ark together.

TRUE

FALSE

7 Genesis 9 says God's promise applies only to Noah, not to his descendants or any future generation.

TRUE

FALSE

PART 3

Literary Craft

Understanding HOW and WHY Genesis tells the story across Genesis 8–11.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **A SIGN IS MORE THAN A DECORATION**

LITERARY CRAFT · SYMBOL

In Genesis 9, God calls the bow in the clouds a **sign** — the word appears again and again in just a few verses. A sign is different from a plain fact. It is something you can see that stands for a promise you cannot see. The bow itself is light and water in the sky, but the passage gives it a job: every time it appears, it points back to God's promise never to flood the whole earth again. Writers use a **symbol** this way on purpose, choosing one visible thing to carry a much bigger meaning. Once you know a symbol's meaning, noticing it again feels different than noticing it for the first **time**.

SYMBOL

A visible thing that stands for a bigger meaning beyond itself. The bow becomes a symbol of God's promise never to flood the whole earth again.

REPETITION

A word or idea repeated on purpose. The word 'sign' appears again and again in Genesis 9 to mark how important the promise is.

MOTIVE

A stated reason for what a character wants or decides to do. The people in Shinar give their own reason for building: to make a name for themselves and avoid being dispersed.

1 What is a symbol?

- ☐ A A visible thing with a meaning beyond itself
- ☐ B A rule for how thick a city wall must be
- ☐ C A full list of one family's descendants
- ☐ D A city renamed after its own founder

2 Fill in the blank with the correct word.

Word choices: **symbol** **repetition** **motive** **mortar** - some words will not be used

The bow becomes a _____ of God's promise once it is given that meaning in Genesis 9.

3 Why does the word 'sign' appear so many times in Genesis 9:12–17?

- ☐ A Because repeating words is always a mistake
- ☐ B To describe a new promise every time
- ☐ C To mark how important the promise is
- ☐ D Because the author forgot other words

4 The people in Shinar give their own stated reason for building the city and tower.

TRUE

FALSE

5 A repeated word in a Bible passage is always an accident and never done on purpose.

TRUE

FALSE

6 Fill in the blank with the correct word.

Word choices: motive symbol repetition dispersed - some words will not be used

A stated reason for what a character wants is called a _____.

Check

7 What does noticing the people's stated motive in Genesis 11 help a reader do?

(A) Prove exactly how every ancient language began

(B) Decide where the real city of Babel stood today

(C) Replace the passage's own reason with a new one

(D) Understand why they build instead of guessing

PART 4

Wisdom

Four deeper challenges — no single-word recall. Read, weigh the evidence, and reason it out.



Treasure Wisdom · a true fact behind the story **ZIGGURATS: ANCIENT MESOPOTAMIA'S TALLEST TOWERS**

ARCHAEOLOGY · MATERIAL EVIDENCE

Ancient Mesopotamia built its temples upward, not outward. A **ziggurat** was a massive stepped tower of sun-dried and baked mudbrick, with a shrine at the top. The best-known example, the Great Ziggurat of Ur, was begun around 2100 BC by King Ur-Nammu and probably finished under his son. Archaeologist Leonard Woolley's team excavated it in the 1920s and 1930s; only its massive base and staircases have survived to be measured directly, since the shrine at the top is long gone. Ziggurats were not houses or forts; each belonged to a city and its god. Genesis 11 never uses the word ziggurat, but it describes people in the same region building upward with the same **brick-and-bitumen** construction archaeologists have **found**.

Read Genesis 8–11 in your Bible first. Notice how Noah tests the water three separate times before he ever leaves the ark, and what changes each time. Then look closely at the promise God makes and the sign he gives it — Genesis 9 stops right after that promise, and this workbook does too. Finally, follow the people who settle in Shinar, the materials they choose to build with, and what they hope building a tall tower and a city will do for them. Keep the passage's own words about being dispersed separate from any guess about how every language in the world actually began.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

1

Claim: "Genesis 8–9 shows Noah responding carefully to the flood's end, and God making a lasting promise afterward." — choose the **three** details that best support it.

God tells Noah and his sons to be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth.

Noah sends out a raven, then a dove three separate times, before leaving the ark.

God gives the bow as a sign of a promise never to flood the whole earth again.

Noah is six hundred and one years old when the earth finally dries.

Noah builds an altar and offers a sacrifice once he leaves the ark.

The ark comes to rest on the mountains of Ararat.

God permits Noah's family to eat meat for the first time.

Check (choose 3)

2 Stated in Genesis 8–9, or Not stated there? **Tap each** detail to send it left or right.

◀ Stated in Genesis 8–9

Not stated there ▶

TAP TO SORT Noah sends a raven out first.

TAP TO SORT The dove returns with a freshly plucked olive leaf.

TAP TO SORT The bow is called a sign of the covenant.

TAP TO SORT The bow is named after a Mesopotamian god.

TAP TO SORT Noah built the altar out of bitumen and brick.

TAP TO SORT The dove speaks to Noah when it returns.

Check

3 Match each first detail with the detail paired with it.

Raven → choose the matching detail... ▼

Olive leaf → choose the matching detail... ▼

The bow → choose the matching detail... ▼

Shinar → choose the matching detail... ▼

Bitumen → choose the matching detail... ▼

Check

4 Fill **both** blanks to complete the reasoning.

The people in Shinar choose brick instead of stone and bitumen instead of mortar-stone

because , which shows that

.

Check

World Discovery (SAT/TOEFL)

Reading passage · Many Languages in One Ancient Land · Ancient Writing and Careful Evidence · practices the same reading-comprehension skills tested on the **SAT** and **TOEFL**: main idea, detail, vocabulary in context, inference and synthesis.

 Read the passage below (the **highlighted** words are tested), then answer the questions. **Tap an answer to select it, tap again to confirm** — you get one chance to change it before it's final.

Original passage written for this workbook — not a quotation from Scripture.

Many Languages in One Ancient Land

Ancient Mesopotamia was home to more than one language. Sumerian and Akkadian were both written with the same wedge-shaped cuneiform signs, but they were separate languages with their own grammar. Scribes in training even **aligned** word lists that matched a Sumerian word beside its Akkadian meaning, almost like a two-language dictionary carved in clay. These bilingual word lists were copied and studied for roughly two thousand years, long after Sumerian stopped being anyone's everyday spoken language. Trade routes and city life constantly brought speakers of different languages into contact with each other. Mesopotamia sat along paths used by travelers, traders, and messengers moving between distant regions. Thousands of these clay tablets have survived in the region's dry soil, and scholars have spent well over a century learning to read them again after the skill had been lost for centuries. A single word list cannot show exactly how every language in the world began, but it does show that ancient Mesopotamia's cities were places where more than one language could be heard in the same street.

1 What is the passage mostly about?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Main Idea

- ☐ (A) Instructions for baking clay tablets correctly
- ☐ (B) Evidence for more than one Mesopotamian language
- ☐ (C) A full translation of the Sumerian language
- ☐ (D) A complete timeline of every Mesopotamian king

2 Which two languages does the passage name?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) Hebrew and Aramaic
- ☐ (B) Egyptian and Greek
- ☐ (C) Sumerian and Akkadian
- ☐ (D) Latin and Phoenician

3 In this passage, “aligned” most nearly means ____.

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Vocabulary in Context

- ☐ (A) lined up and matched together
- ☐ (B) translated into a new language
- ☐ (C) buried deep underground
- ☐ (D) erased on purpose

4 What evidence shows scribes worked with two languages at once?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Detail

- ☐ (A) A single tablet written in one language only
- ☐ (B) Word lists that pair Sumerian and Akkadian words
- ☐ (C) A drawing that shows two scribes arguing
- ☐ (D) A list of kings ruling two different cities

5 Why might Mesopotamia's cities have had speakers of different languages nearby each other?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Inference

- ☐ (A) Every city agreed to use only one shared language
- ☐ (B) Clay tablets were too heavy to carry between cities
- ☐ (C) Trade routes connected speakers of different languages
- ☐ (D) Scribes were forbidden from learning a second language

6 What kind of evidence does the passage rely on to make its point?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Evidence

- ☐ (A) A single scholar's personal opinion
- ☐ (B) A modern survey of living languages
- ☐ (C) A legend with no physical evidence at all
- ☐ (D) Clay tablets recovered from the ground

7 According to the passage, what can and cannot a single word list show?

SAT/TOEFL Reading · Synthesis

- ☐ (A) It shows two languages in use, not how language began
- ☐ (B) It proves exactly how every human language began
- ☐ (C) It cannot show anything reliable about Mesopotamia
- ☐ (D) It shows the exact date every tablet was written

Writing

A print-only writing prompt — not part of your online score.

Writing Task — Part 4 “A Sign That Means Something”

In Genesis 9, God gives the bow in the clouds as a sign of his promise. A sign can be a small thing that stands for something bigger — a handshake, a note, or a certain place. Think of a sign or symbol in your own life that reminds you of a promise or a memory. What is it, and what does it remind you of? 4–6 sentences. End by saying why that sign matters to you.

You can start with: *“One sign that reminds me of...”*

Write your response on paper or in a notebook. This section is for print and take-home use; it is not scored online.